

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Associations converged into an all-India platform

1851 BRITISH INDIAN ASSOCIATION -> elite articulation in Bengal

1866 EAST INDIA ASSOCIATION -> Indian claims before British opinion

1870 POONA SARVAJANIK SABHA -> public representation in western India

1876 INDIAN ASSOCIATION -> broader political mobilisation

1884-85 MADRAS / BOMBAY BODIES -> regional networks ready for Congress

DEC 1885 INC -> one annual all-India platform, not a political beginning from zero.

MUST REMEMBER: The INC met first at Bombay in December 1885 under W.C. Bonnerjee; A.O. Hume mattered organisationally, but Indian associations, economic critique and political networks predated it.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: The first Congress session identity card

PLACE -> Bombay

DATE -> December 1885

DELEGATES -> 72

PRESIDENT -> W.C. Bonnerjee

ORGANISER -> A.O. Hume helped convene

EXAM LIMIT -> organiser does not equal creator of Indian nationalism.

ASCTI MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Safety valve versus national movement

SAFETY-VALVE CLAIM -> Hume channelled dangerous discontent

PROBLEM 1 -> motive of one organiser cannot explain a social movement

PROBLEM 2 -> associations, press and grievances existed before 1885

NATIONAL-MOVEMENT THESIS -> Indian forces supplied cause and content

BALANCED VERDICT -> Hume explains facilitation, not historical ownership.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Moderate constitutional repertoire

GRIEVANCE -> resolution at annual Congress

RESOLUTION -> petition, memorial and press campaign

PUBLICITY -> meetings, newspapers and British deputations

INSTITUTION -> legislative question and budget criticism

PURPOSE -> educate Indian opinion and pressure imperial liberalism

CEILING -> the colonial executive retained decisive power.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Economic nationalism made poverty political

DRAIN -> resources transferred without equivalent return

DEINDUSTRIALISATION -> older production weakened under dependent trade

REVENUE PRESSURE -> cultivators carried fiscal risk

MILITARY COST -> Indian revenues financed imperial priorities

SERVICE EXCLUSION -> salaries and authority remained racially unequal

CONCLUSION -> poverty became an indictment of colonial structure.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Demand map of the Moderates

COUNCILS -> enlargement, elective principle, questions and budgets

SERVICES -> Indianisation and simultaneous ICS examinations

FINANCE -> lower military spending and scrutiny of home charges

RIGHTS -> speech, press and association

ADMINISTRATION -> accountability and racial equality

BOUNDARY -> reform of empire, not immediate complete independence.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Indian Councils Act 1892: gain and ceiling

GAIN -> enlarged legislative councils

GAIN -> indirect election-like recommending bodies

GAIN -> budget discussion and questions

NO GAIN -> elected majority

NO GAIN -> executive responsibility or budget control

VERDICT -> procedure expanded while colonial power remained intact.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Annual Congress as political education

ANNUAL SESSION -> leaders compare regional grievances

COMMON LANGUAGE -> rights, economy, representation and accountability

PRESS REPRODUCTION -> arguments reach provincial publics

COUNCIL PRACTICE -> evidence, questions and budget criticism improve

NEW PUBLIC -> Indians imagine a shared political community

LOOP -> public pressure strengthens the next annual session.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: The social-base paradox

STRENGTH -> educated lawyers, journalists and teachers mastered print and law

STRENGTH -> presidency-town networks enabled all-India coordination

LIMIT -> peasants, workers, women and many lower castes remained outside

LIMIT -> English and institutional politics restricted access

RESULT -> strong argument and weak mass reach

NEXT PHASE -> boycott sought mobilisation beyond the petitioning elite.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Achievement depends on the measuring scale

POWER TRANSFER -> LOW: no responsible government

PROCEDURAL OPENING -> LIMITED: 1892 councils

ECONOMIC CRITIQUE -> HIGH: colonial exploitation exposed

ORGANISATION -> HIGH: enduring all-India platform

POLITICAL EDUCATION -> HIGH: trained leaders and public opinion

VERDICT -> immediate failure coexisted with foundational success.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: The 'safety-valve' claim is not an adequate monocausal origin theory;

Moderate constitutional methods could be limited yet still create an all-India political vocabulary and economic indictment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Moderates to militants: continuity and rupture

CONTINUITY -> drain critique and colonial economic indictment

CONTINUITY -> Congress as the national organisational arena

CONTINUITY -> civil liberties and representative claims

RUPTURE -> faith in British justice declined

RUPTURE -> petition yielded to boycott, self-reliance and passive resistance

1905 -> limitation of one method generated the next repertoire.

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Nationalist, Cambridge and subaltern accounts should be compared through membership, petitions, associations, press and provincial participation, including the movement's narrow early social base.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Moderate answer-writing spine

DEFINE -> constitutional nationalism with an educated middle-class base
ORIGIN -> pre-1885 associations plus common colonial grievances
METHOD -> petition, press, councils and deputations
ACHIEVEMENT -> organisation, economic critique and political education
LIMIT -> narrow reach, loyalist faith and limited concessions
VERDICT -> failed to gain power, succeeded in making later struggle possible.